County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, August 10, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395633**

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:08 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member Paula Brown

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Vice-Chair Tabernik led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to amend the agenda to go back into Executive Session at the end of the Council Meeting.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member McElynn.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 7:3.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The amended motion passed 10:0

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the minutes from Caucus and County Council July 13, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Abstaining: Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 9:0:1.

6. Proclamation

a. Proclamation recognizing the 500th Anniversary of Santa Elena

Chair Howard presented a proclamation to Chris Allen, a representative of the Beaufort County Historical Society and the Santa Elena Society recognizing the 500th Anniversary of Santa Elena.

7. Administrator's Report

Michael Moore, County Administrator, presented retirement and longevity awards to county employees and gave an update on the Transportation Sales Tax Referendum. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395633

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395633**

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Council Members gave updates on county agencies, boards, and committees. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395633

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson,

Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Community Services and Public Safety Committee Meeting

1. Authorize the County Administrator to enter into a contract with EMS Management & Consultants, Inc to provide billing services for Beaufort County EMS.

2. Authorize the County Administrator to enter into a contract with Cedars Business Services, LLC to provide billing collection services for Beaufort County Emergency Medical Services.

3. Authorize the County Administrator to approve an open purchase order not to exceed $300,000 to facilitate the purchase of medical supplies for Beaufort County Emergency Medical Services.

4. Approve the purchase of Ten (10) LifePak 35, cardiac monitors and associated accessories.

5. Authorize the County Administrator to enter a contact for service with Trinity Services Group for Beaufort County Detention Center Food Services Program.

b. Items Originating from the Natural Resources Committee

1. Authorization for the county administrator to enter into an agreement for a public-private partnership with Brickyard Commons, LLC for a Royal Pines drainage project.

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Agenda Items

a. Authorization for the County Administrator to negotiate a Lease agreement with Coosaw Community Association Regarding the Coosaw Community Center.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the authorization for the County Administrator to negotiate a Lease Agreement with Coosaw Community Association regarding the Coosaw Community Center.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

b. Approval of updated 2026 County Council Meeting Calendar

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the updated 2026 County Council Meeting Calendar.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

c. Appointment of Mark Hagood to the Seabrook Point Property Owners Association for a partial term with an expiration date of February 2027.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to take items 11.c through 11.m as one item.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve all appointments and reappointments.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

d. Reappointment of Dean Nadler to the Seabrook Point Owners Association for a 2nd term of four years with an expiration date of July 2030.

e. Reappointment of Arthur Handman to the Beaufort County Transportation Committee for a 2nd term of four-years with an expiration date of July 2030.

f. Reappointment of Alvin Green to the Beaufort-Jasper Economic Opportunity Commission for a 2nd term of four years with an expiration date of July 2030.

g. Appointment of Ross Vezin to the Lowcountry Workforce Development Board, as a Labor Representative for a partial term with an expiration date of June 2028.

h. Appointment of Christina Jackson to the Lowcountry Workforce Development Board, as a representative of the Business Sector for a first term of three-years with an expiration date of June 2029.

i. Reappointment of Melanie Gallion to the Lowcountry Workforce Development Board, as a representative of the Higher Education Sector for a sixth term of three-years with an expiration date of June 2029.

j. Reappointment of Ed Saxon to the Military Enhancement Committee (MEC) for a three-year term with an expiration date of July 2029.

k. Appointment of Eric Berman to the Military Enhancement Committee (MEC) for a three-year term with an expiration date of July 2029.

l. Recommend approval to the Governor's Office for the reappointment of Wendy Bukowski to the Disabilities and Special Needs Board for a 3rd term of four years, with an expiration date of July 2030.

m. Reappointment of William Rickett to the Bluffton Township Fire District Board for a 2nd term of four-years with an expiration date of July 2030 (pending approval by the Town of Bluffton)

12. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/37: An Ordinance authorizing the abandonment of County Maintenance of a portion of Gibson Drive following petition by adjacent property owners and reclassifying said portion as a Private Road. **PUBLIC HEARING**
The vote at Public Facilities Committee on June 15, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading on July 13, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Third Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/37.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

b. 2026/38: An Ordinance to amend Ordinance 2017/12 to appropriate funds from the 2017 Series General Obligation Bond to the Station 34 joint Fire/EMS Station. **PUBLIC HEARING**
The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading on July 13, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Third Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/38.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

c. 2026/39: An Ordinance to amend the Fiscal Year 2027 Budget Ordinance to carry forward purchase orders and funds from Fiscal Year 2026 and prior for projects that have not yet been completed. **PUBLIC HEARING**
The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading on July 13, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Third Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/39.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

d. 2026/40: An Ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $1,496,825.73 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury. **PUBLIC HEARING**
The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading on July 13, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve Third Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/40.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

13. Ordinances for First Reading:

a. 2026/41: An Ordinance amending the Community Development Code (CDC): section 5.3.20 (applicability), 4.2.20 (standards for free-standing accessory buildings/structures), 5.8.100 (screening), and 10.1.190 (definitions).

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on August 3, 2026 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/41 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals, objectives, and policies of the comprehensive plan; it is not in conflict with any provision of this development code or the code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is consistent with the purpose and intent of the zones in this development code, or would improve compatibility among uses and ensure efficient development within the county; it would result in a logical and orderly development pattern; and it would not result in adverse impacts on the natural environment including but not limited to water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

b. 2026/42: An Ordinance amending the zoning map for 1.4 acres (R300 012 000 0129 0000, R300 012 000 047A 0000) from T2R to T2RC.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on August 3, 2026 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/42 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the comprehensive code and the purposes of the development code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the development code and or our code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would not adversely affect nearby land; it would result in logical and orderly development patterns; it would not result in adverse impact on the natural environment, water, air, noise, stormwater

management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment; and it would result in development that is adequately served by public facilities, streets, potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

14. Resolutions

a. 2026/27: A Resolution for Military Infrastructure Resilience and All Hazards Decision Support Program Proposal

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/27.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/32: A Resolution to create an Ad Hoc committee for Animal Services.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/32.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

c. 2026/33: A Resolution to adopt an updated parks and recreation fee schedule for programming and facility use.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/33.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

d. 2026/34: A Resolution To Allocate Funds From The South Carolina Opioid Settlement.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/34.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

e. 2026/35: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute a Memorandum of Agreement to engage in discussions about improvements and usage of the Battle of Port Royal Island site, subject to appropriate approval and securing of funding.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/35.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

15. Adjournment

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to go back into Executive Session.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Passiment that Council authorize the Beaufort County Treasurer to award the Treasurer's Department Employees the 3% salary increase for FY 2027 as requested, which will be considered to be a 1% COLA and a 2% merit increase, and that the 2% salary increase be authorized effective July 1, 2026, in conjunction with the COLA increase rather than on the anniversary of the employee assuming their current position, and further that no additional merit increase be approved without the consent of Council.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:0.

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: September 14, 2026